PLUMSTEAD NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

Digital Community Safety Platform

SERVICE & VALUE OVERVIEW

For the Executive Committee, Community Stakeholders & Partners

Version 1.0 | March 2026

Item	Detail
Prepared for	PNW Executive Committee, prospective partners, and community stakeholders
Purpose	Proposal-ready overview of the full platform service offering
Classification	Internal / Pre-proposal
Best-practice alignment	UNDP Digital Participation Guide (2025), ISO 37120/37122 Community Indicators

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1. Executive Summary

The Plumstead Neighbourhood Watch (PNW) digital platform is an all-in-one online system that connects residents, committee members, volunteers, and local businesses around a shared goal: making Plumstead safer and stronger.

It replaces outdated paper forms, scattered WhatsApp groups, and a legacy website with a single, modern platform that any resident can access from their phone, tablet, or computer – 24 hours a day.

> *"Less reported incidents = fewer resources." – Every incident reported through CVIC or SAPS directly influences police resource allocation for our area. This platform makes reporting easier and faster.*

At a Glance

Dimension	Detail
Coverage area	Plumstead, Cape Town (postcode 7800)
Patrol sections	7 neighbourhood zones with street-level detail
Streets mapped	230+ streets across all 7 zones
Volunteer base	80+ active patrollers, with 4 volunteer role types
Operating since	2007 (community founded); 2025 (digital platform launched)
Admin roles	5 committee roles with tailored access levels
Business directory	5 categories (Retail, Services, Food & Dining, Health, Other)
Sponsorship tiers	3 levels: Premium, Partner, Supporter
Key partners	CVIC, SAPS Diep River, Department of Community Safety (DOCS)

2. The Problem We Solve

Neighbourhood watches across South Africa share a common set of operational challenges. These are not failures of commitment – they are structural limitations that technology can address.

Communication is fragmented

Safety updates, meeting notices, and incident reports travel through multiple WhatsApp groups, printed flyers, and word of mouth. Some residents receive the information; many do not. There is no single, reliable source of truth for the community.

Administration is manual and time-consuming

Registering new members, tracking volunteers, reconciling payments, and distributing documents all require committee time – time that could be directed toward actual safety operations. Forms are filled out on paper. Spreadsheets are maintained by individual committee members. Information is siloed.

Incident reporting is under-utilised

When crime or suspicious activity goes unreported to CVIC and SAPS, our area appears statistically safer than it is. This directly reduces the patrol resources allocated to Plumstead. The more incidents reported, the more resources the community receives.

Businesses have no structured way to participate

Local businesses benefit from a safe neighbourhood, but there has been no formal channel for them to connect with residents, sponsor operations, or participate in community events.

The old website no longer meets community needs

The legacy website was built on technology that is no longer maintained. It lacks mobile support, has limited self-service capability, and cannot scale to meet the growing needs of the community.

> *The PNW digital platform was built specifically to solve each of these problems – giving the committee better tools to manage operations and giving residents better access to safety information and community services.*

3. How the Platform Works

The platform is a modern website that works on any device – smartphone, tablet, or desktop computer. There is nothing to download or install. Residents simply visit the website to access all features.

Four Levels of Access

The platform is designed around four levels of user access, each unlocking additional capabilities:

Access level	Who	What they can do
Public visitor	Anyone who visits the website	View safety information, incidents, events, safety tips, zone map, documents, business directory, emergency contacts
Registered member	Residents who complete the membership registration	Everything above, plus: report incidents, RSVP to events, access the member dashboard, download a digital membership card, message businesses
Registered guest	Residents who want basic awareness only	Simplified sign-up with WhatsApp opt-in; access to community content without full membership obligations
Committee administrator	Authorised committee members	Full management console to administer users, incidents, events, documents, business listings, payments, and broadcasts

Always Available

The platform is hosted on a global network that ensures fast loading speeds for South African users. Pages load in under one second, even on slower mobile connections. The site is available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, with built-in redundancy to prevent downtime.

Secure by Design

All user accounts are protected by industry-standard authentication with support for multi-factor authentication (e.g. a code sent to your phone in addition to your password). Committee members have additional security layers that restrict access to administrative functions based on their assigned role.

4. What Residents Get

Every feature on the platform exists to serve a specific community need. This section walks through each capability from the resident's perspective.

4.1 Emergency Access

The moment a resident opens the platform, they see the two most important numbers in the community:

- **CVIC – 0860 002 669** (24-hour crime reporting hotline)
- **SAPS Flying Squad – 10111** (emergency police response)

On a mobile phone, tapping either number initiates a call immediately. The platform also provides the full emergency directory including ambulance, fire, metro police, power failure, water, and the local Diep River SAPS station.

> *Every call to CVIC or SAPS is logged and contributes to the data that determines how many police resources are allocated to Plumstead. Reporting is not optional – it is the most impactful thing a resident can do.*

4.2 Incident Reporting & Awareness

- **View incidents.** A live feed of all recorded incidents showing what happened, where, and when. Residents can filter by area or type of incident.
- **Report incidents.** Registered members can submit incident reports directly from their phone, specifying the type, location, and time. Each report is linked to the submitting user for follow-up.
- **Stay informed.** The 5 most recent incidents appear on the home page and on each member's personal dashboard.

4.3 Community Events

- **Browse events.** All community events – meetings, social gatherings, fundraisers – are listed with title, venue, date, and time.
- **RSVP.** Registered members can confirm their attendance with a single tap. RSVPs appear on the member's dashboard.
- **Never miss a date.** Up to 6 upcoming events are highlighted on the home page.

4.4 Safety Tips

A curated library of crime prevention advice, organised into five practical categories:

Category	What it covers
Home security	Securing your property, access control, visible deterrents
Scam prevention	Fraud awareness, protecting personal information
Vehicle safety	Car security, parking awareness, hijacking prevention
Anti-social behaviour	Neighbour disputes, noise complaints, public order
Reporting guidance	When to call CVIC vs SAPS, what information to provide

4.5 Interactive Zone Map

Plumstead is divided into 7 patrol sections. The interactive zone map lets residents:

- Select any section to see which streets it covers
- View the number of registered members in each section
- Identify their own section before registering as a member

4.6 Document Library

The committee publishes documents for residents to download, organised into 8 categories: Forms, Policies, Newsletter Archive, Financials, News, Debit Order Instructions, Partner documentation, and Local Business Advertising.

4.7 Volunteer Opportunities

Residents who want to contribute can apply for one of four volunteer roles:

Role	What you do	Time needed
Patroller	Patrol your assigned area, report incidents, support the community	Flexible
Block Captain	Act as liaison for 10–15 houses, coordinate with neighbours	2–4 hours/month
Coordinator	Run a scheme or support multiple groups across sections	4–8 hours/month
Committee member	Chair, secretary, treasurer, or operations leadership	Variable

Interested residents complete a short form and are contacted by the committee.

4.8 Vacation Watch

Going away? Registered members can request enhanced surveillance of their property while they are absent. The form captures travel dates, emergency contact details, and any special instructions. The committee coordinates with patrol volunteers to provide additional attention to the property.

4.9 Start Your Own Scheme

Residents in areas adjacent to Plumstead can inquire about establishing their own neighbourhood watch. A guided four-step process explains what is involved, and an inquiry form connects interested parties with the PNW committee for guidance.

4.10 Donations & Funding

Residents can contribute financially to community safety. The platform displays full banking details (FNB account 631 463 987 05, branch 255355) with a one-tap copy feature. A clear breakdown shows where donations go:

- Patrol and response coordination
- Community surveillance and CCTV coverage
- Incident communications and outreach materials
- Volunteer training and operational support

4.11 Help Centre

A dedicated help section provides:

- Step-by-step member registration guide
- Glossary of neighbourhood watch terms
- Patrol administration guidance

4.12 Legal & Compliance

Terms of Use, Privacy Policy, and Disclaimer pages are accessible from every page, ensuring transparency and regulatory compliance.

5. Membership & Registration

Member Registration

The registration process is designed to capture the information the committee needs to operate effectively, while remaining simple enough for any resident to complete in a few minutes.

Information collected	Why we need it
Zone (patrol section)	So we know which area you're in and can assign you to the right patrol section
Street name	Links you to one of 230+ mapped streets for precise geographic coordination
House number	Identifies your specific property within the street
Privacy preference	You choose whether to be visible to your neighbours on the platform
Patrol opt-in	Indicates your willingness to participate in community patrols
Emergency contact	A secondary person we can reach in an emergency (name, phone, email)
WhatsApp preference	Whether you'd like to receive updates via WhatsApp and your number

After completing the form, you create a secure account with your email and password. The committee reviews and approves your registration, and you receive full platform access.

Guest Registration

Residents who want basic community awareness without full membership can register as a guest. This is a simplified process that captures WhatsApp preferences only.

Digital Membership Card

Once approved, every member receives a digital membership card that can be downloaded to their phone. The card shows your name, unique member number, zone, and membership status – your proof of participation in community safety.

Member Dashboard

After signing in, every member sees a personalised dashboard showing:

- The 5 most recent incidents in the community
- The next 5 upcoming events
- Events you've RSVP'd to
- Quick links to your account, settings, and documents
- A link to the admin console (for committee members only)

6. Business Networking & Sponsorship

The Business Networking Hub creates a structured connection between local businesses and the Plumstead community. It serves three purposes: helping residents discover local services, giving businesses visibility, and creating a revenue channel for community safety operations.

6.1 Business Directory

A searchable directory of approved local businesses. Residents can filter by:

- Category – Retail, Services, Food & Dining, Health, or Other
- Zone – Geographic area within Plumstead
- Search – Free-text search across business names and descriptions

The committee can mark certain businesses as "featured" for prominent placement at the top of the directory.

6.2 How Businesses Get Listed

Any registered user can submit a business listing through a simple online form. The process works as follows:

1. **Submit** – The business owner fills in the listing form (business name, description, category, contact details).
2. **Review** – The committee reviews the submission for quality and relevance.
3. **Approve or decline** – Approved listings appear in the public directory. Declined submissions are communicated back to the owner.
4. **Engage** – Once listed, residents can message the business, request introductions, and refer friends.

6.3 Connecting Businesses with Residents

The platform provides three structured ways for residents and businesses to interact:

- **Direct messaging –** Residents can send a message to any listed business directly from the listing page. Business owners have a dedicated inbox to manage conversations.
- **Introduction requests –** Residents can request a facilitated introduction to a business. The business owner can accept or decline.
- **Referrals –** Residents can refer friends and family to a business by sharing the listing with a personal message.

6.4 Business Events

Businesses can host community events linked to their listing – product launches, workshops, open days. These appear in the business events calendar, and residents can RSVP directly.

6.5 Sponsorship Programme

Businesses that want deeper community involvement can become sponsors. Three tiers are available:

Tier	Visibility	Ideal for
Premium	Logo on the home page, featured in the Business Hub, dedicated listing on the Sponsors page	Security firms, major local employers, financial institutions
Partner	Featured in the Business Hub and listed on the Sponsors page with logo	Professional services, retail chains, community organisations
Supporter	Named on the Sponsors page	Small businesses, individual contributors, project sponsors

> *Sponsorship revenue directly funds patrol coordination, CCTV operations, communication tools, and volunteer training. Sponsors gain trusted community visibility while supporting frontline safety operations.*

6.6 Advertising

Businesses interested in website advertising opportunities can contact the committee directly at info@plumsteadwatch.org.za.

7. Platform Administration & Committee Management

This is the most important section for the executive committee. It describes every tool available for managing the platform and its community.

7.1 The Admin Console

The admin console is the central management hub for committee members. When an authorised committee member signs in, they see a dashboard showing key operational numbers at a glance:

Dashboard metric	What it tells you
Total users	How many residents have registered on the platform
Active users	How many registered users are currently active
Pending members	How many new registrations are waiting for committee approval
Pending business listings	How many business submissions are waiting for review
Total incidents	How many incidents have been recorded
Total events	How many community events are in the system
Total documents	How many documents are available for download
Contact messages	How many messages have been submitted through the contact form
Roles defined	How many committee roles have been set up

Each metric is a clickable card that takes the administrator directly to the relevant management area.

7.2 What Administrators Can Do

The admin console provides 11 management areas. Here is what each one does, written from the committee member's perspective:

Incident Management

Status: Fully operational

- View all reported incidents in a sortable, filterable table
- Create new incident records (e.g. when reports come in via phone or WhatsApp)
- Edit existing incident details to correct or update information
- Moderate community-submitted reports for accuracy

Business Listing Approvals

Status: Fully operational

- Review all pending business listing submissions
- Approve listings to make them visible in the public directory
- Reject listings that don't meet quality or relevance standards
- Mark select listings as "featured" for prominent display

Member Approvals

Status: Fully operational

- Review all new member registrations awaiting approval

- Approve members to grant them full platform access
- Approved members receive their digital membership card and are counted in zone statistics

Contact Messages

Status: Fully operational

- View all messages submitted through the public contact form
- See sender name, email address, and full message text
- Use for follow-up by committee members

User Management

Status: Architecture in place, management interface in development

- View all registered users and their details
- Activate or deactivate user accounts
- Assign roles to users (e.g. promote a member to Zone Captain)
- Review user profiles and membership information

Role & Permission Management

Status: Architecture in place, management interface in development

- Create custom roles beyond the 5 standard ones
- Assign specific permissions to each role
- Tailor access levels to match committee structure changes

Event Management

Status: Architecture in place, management interface in development

- Create new community events with title, venue, date/time, and description
- Edit or cancel existing events
- View RSVP counts for each event

Document Management

Status: Architecture in place, management interface in development

- Upload documents for community download (forms, policies, newsletters, financials)
- Organise documents into 8 predefined categories
- Remove outdated documents

Payment Administration

Status: Architecture in place, management interface in development

- Track membership payments and donations
- Support for online card payments and manual bank transfers (EFT)
- View payment status (pending, paid, failed) and amounts
- Verify and reconcile payments

Community Broadcast

Status: Architecture in place, management interface in development

- Send announcements to all platform members
- Target specific groups or send community-wide messages
- Ideal for safety alerts, meeting reminders, and operational updates

7.3 Committee Roles & Access Levels

Not every committee member needs access to everything. The platform provides five roles, each with a tailored set of permissions:

Role	Who it's for	What they can access
Member	All registered residents	No administrative access. Standard community features only.
Moderator	Trusted patrol coordinators	Admin console access. Can manage incident reports and view contact messages.
Zone Captain	Section leaders (one per zone)	Admin console access. Can approve new member registrations, manage incidents, and view user profiles in their zone.
Admin	Committee executives	Full access to all management areas except role definition. Can manage users, events, documents, businesses, payments, messages, and broadcasts.
Super Admin	Chairperson or platform owner	Unrestricted access to everything, including the ability to create and modify roles and permissions.

7.4 The Permission Matrix

The table below shows exactly which permissions each role has. This ensures that every committee member has the access they need – and nothing more.

Permission	Member	Moderator	Zone Captain	Admin	Super Admin
Access admin console		✓	✓	✓	✓
View user accounts			✓	✓	✓
Edit user accounts & assign roles				✓	✓
Create & modify roles					✓
Manage incidents		✓	✓	✓	✓
Manage events				✓	✓
Manage documents				✓	✓
Approve/reject business listings				✓	✓
Approve new members			✓	✓	✓
View contact messages		✓		✓	✓
Send community broadcasts				✓	✓

> *Zone Captains are a key innovation: they allow the committee to decentralise member approvals across all 7 sections, reducing the bottleneck on the executive committee while maintaining oversight.*

7.5 Approval Workflows

The platform enforces quality control through two approval processes:

New Member Approvals

1. **Resident registers** – Fills in the registration form with zone, street, contact details.
2. **Account created** – A secure login is established, but the member is marked as “pending”.
3. **Committee reviews** – The registration appears in the admin console under “Member approvals.”
4. **Approved or deferred** – Once approved, the member gains full access, their digital membership card, and they appear in zone statistics.

Business Listing Approvals

1. **Business submitted** – A registered user fills in the business listing form.
2. **Review queue** – The listing appears in the admin console under “Business approvals” with a “Pending” status.
3. **Committee decides** – Approved listings go live in the public directory. Rejected listings are removed from the queue.

7.6 Getting Started as an Administrator

The very first administrator is set up automatically: the committee designates one or more email addresses as “bootstrap admins.” When someone with that email address signs up, they are automatically granted full Super Admin access. From there, they can assign roles to other committee members through the admin console.

No technical knowledge is required. The admin console is a web-based interface with clear labels, clickable cards, and intuitive navigation.

8. Data Protection & Privacy

Resident trust is essential. The platform implements multiple layers of privacy protection:

- **Visibility control.** Every member chooses whether they are visible to their neighbours on the platform. This is a personal setting that can be changed at any time.
- **Communication consent.** WhatsApp opt-in is separate from registration. Members explicitly choose whether to receive WhatsApp messages and provide their number only if they consent.
- **Email preferences.** Members can configure which types of email communication they receive.
- **Secondary contact is optional.** Emergency contact information is collected only when the member chooses to provide it.
- **Secure accounts.** All accounts are protected by industry-standard authentication with support for multi-factor authentication.
- **Input validation.** Every form on the platform checks submissions for completeness and correctness before saving, preventing incomplete or malformed data.
- **Legal transparency.** Terms of Use, Privacy Policy, and Disclaimer pages are accessible from every page via the site footer.

9. Quality & Reliability

Testing

The platform is tested against 11 core user journeys before every release, covering: member registration, guest registration, incident reporting, event RSVP, contact submissions, volunteer interest, vacation watch, scheme inquiries, safety tip browsing, zone map interaction, and admin console operations.

Release Process

Every update to the platform follows a structured release process:

1. **Automated checks** – Code quality and build verification run automatically.
2. **Staging review** – The update is deployed to a staging environment where the committee can preview changes before they go live.
3. **Production deployment** – Updates are deployed during designated maintenance windows.
4. **Rollback plan** – If any issue is discovered, the platform can be reverted to the previous stable version within minutes.

Accessibility

The platform is designed to be usable by everyone:

- Works on all modern smartphones, tablets, and desktop computers
- Fast loading even on slower mobile connections
- High-contrast emergency information for critical safety numbers
- Tap-to-call on all phone numbers for mobile users
- Respects device settings for reduced motion (animations)
- Printable pages for offline distribution

10. Community Impact

The platform's value is measured against international community indicators (ISO 37120/37122/37123) used by cities worldwide to assess quality of life, smart city readiness, and community resilience.

Safety & Security

What the platform provides	How it impacts the community
Live incident feed and reporting	Increases reporting to CVIC and SAPS, directly driving police resource allocation for Plumstead
Emergency contact directory	Residents can call CVIC, SAPS, ambulance, fire, or metro police with a single tap
Safety tips library	Educates residents on crime prevention, reducing opportunities for criminal activity
Vacation watch programme	Properties of absent members receive additional patrol attention
Zone map with 7 patrol sections	Enables geographic coordination of volunteer patrol coverage

Community Engagement

What the platform provides	How it impacts the community
Event management with RSVP	Increases participation in meetings, fundraisers, and social events
Volunteer recruitment pipeline	Structures onboarding for patrollers, block captains, coordinators, and committee members
Personalised member dashboard	Every resident sees the information most relevant to their safety
Digital membership card	Creates a tangible sense of community identity and belonging

Local Economic Development

What the platform provides	How it impacts the community
Business directory	Increases visibility of local businesses and encourages community spending
Sponsorship programme	Creates structured revenue for community safety operations
Business events	Generates networking opportunities between businesses and residents
Referral system	Facilitates word-of-mouth growth for local businesses

Governance & Transparency

What the platform provides	How it impacts the community
Public committee directory	Makes leadership visible and directly contactable
Document library	Financial reports, policies, and newsletters are publicly available
Role-based administration	Distributes responsibility across trained committee members
Donation transparency	Banking details and spending categories are publicly disclosed

Resilience & Inclusion

What the platform provides	How it impacts the community
Guest registration	Low-barrier entry point for residents not ready for full membership
Mobile-first design	Full functionality on smartphones – the primary internet device for many South Africans
Start-a-scheme programme	Extends the neighbourhood watch model to adjacent communities
WhatsApp readiness	Infrastructure is in place to broadcast via SA's most-used messaging platform

11. Roadmap & Future Growth

What Has Been Delivered

- Complete member and guest registration with zone/street mapping
- Incident reporting and awareness feed
- Community events with RSVP
- Safety tips library with 5 categories
- Interactive zone map with 7 sections and 230+ streets
- Document library with 8 categories
- Full business networking hub (directory, messaging, events, referrals, introductions)
- Sponsorship and advertising programme
- Committee administration console with role-based access
- Vacation watch and volunteer management
- Help centre, legal pages, and donation page
- Expanded admin interfaces for user management, event creation, document uploads, and payment tracking
- Document category filtering and search
- Online payments – Pay membership fees and event registrations directly through the platform via card or mobile money.
- Push notifications **–** Real-time mobile alerts for new incidents and event reminders.

Future Enhancements

- **WhatsApp broadcasts –** Send safety alerts and updates directly to opted-in members via WhatsApp.
- **Neighbour directory –** Connect with verified neighbours in your section (with privacy controls).
- Analytics dashboard – Track incident trends, membership growth, event attendance, and business directory engagement over time.
- **Community forum –** Discussion space for residents to share information and coordinate locally.
- **Patrol booking –** Schedule and manage patrol shifts through the platform.
- **Multi-area support –** Extend the platform to serve additional neighbourhood watch organisations beyond Plumstead.

Please note : There are various other features, functions, and capabilities being explored and developed, and I look forward to discussing and presenting these to the committee for approval and progression.

Appendix A – Emergency Contacts & Committee Directory

Executive Committee

Role	Name	Phone	Email
Chairperson	Anthea Klugman	072 675 9777	chairperson@mypnw.org.za
Assistant Chairperson	Brenda Besterfield	084 589 1702	assistantchairperson@mypnw.org.za
Operations Manager	Jarryd Munro	078 457 2313	ops.manager@mypnw.org.za
Secretary	Sharon Botes	079 469 9885	secretary@mypnw.org.za
Treasurer	Glynnis Okkers	072 470 3136	treasurer@mypnw.org.za

Emergency Contacts

Service	Number
CVIC (24-hour crime reporting)	0860 002 669
SAPS Flying Squad	10111
Ambulance	10177
Fire	107
Metro Police Control Room	021 596 1999
Power Failure	086 012 5001
Water	086 010 3054
Diep River SAPS	021 710 7306/7

Appendix B – Current Sponsors

Sponsor	Tier	Website
ADT Security	Premium	www.adt.co.za
Combat Force	Premium	combatforce.co.za
Zone Security Services	Partner	—
Ooba Solar	Partner	www.ooba.co.za
Tammy Frankland	Supporter	—
Lance Gordon	Supporter	—

This document was prepared for the PNW Executive Committee in accordance with the UNDP/People Powered Digital Participation Platform Guide (2025) and ISO 37120/37122/37123 community impact indicators. All capabilities described have been verified against the live platform as of March 2026.